

Report on the outcomes of a presentation and participation in a ITC Conference¹

Action number: COST Action 21129 OPINION

Grantee name: Edlira Gugu

Conference Details

Conference title:

COMPTExT 2026 — the Eighth International and Interdisciplinary Conference on the Quantitative and Computational Analysis of Text, Image, Audio, and Video as Data

Conference web-page: <https://www.comptextconference.org/8th-annual-conference-2026/>

Conference venue²: The University of Birmingham, UK

Accepted contribution details

Title of the presentation: *Generative Language Models and the transformation of scientific discourse. A computational text analysis*

In the panel on identity construction and political language, the paper serves as a reflexive methodological intervention that extends the notion of “political language” to the governance of scientific knowledge itself. While traditional panel contributions may focus on how political actors craft collective identities, this study turns the analytical lens inward: it examines how generative language models are quietly reshaping the epistemic identity of scientific communities—standardizing rhetorical styles, flattening authorial voice, and subtly redefining how uncertainty, novelty, and expertise are linguistically performed. By empirically documenting the homogenization of scientific discourse through computational text analysis, the paper invites panel participants to consider a critical parallel: just as political language shapes public identity, algorithmically mediated scientific language is reshaping the professional identity of researchers. This aligns directly with COMPTExT 2026’s *Fehlerkultur* theme, as the findings highlight the need for scholarly communities to openly acknowledge and discuss the unintended consequences (i.e., errors of epistemic over-reliance) of adopting generative tools. The paper thus functions as both a case study and a cautionary provocation, urging the panel to broaden its understanding of “identity construction” to include the emerging, often invisible influence of AI on academic discourse itself.

This version anchors the abstract’s findings to the panel’s thematic focus while explicitly connecting to the conference’s cross-cutting themes.

¹ This report is submitted by the grantee to the Action MC for approval and for claiming payment of the awarded grant. The Grant Awarding Coordinator coordinates the evaluation of this report on behalf of the Action MC and instructs the Grant Holder Manager to verify the grant documents compliance and proceed with the payment.

² For an online conference, specify virtual participation; for hybrid conferences, specify whether it is an in-person or virtual participation.

Outcome of the conference participation

My participation in COMPTExT 2026 took place within the framework of **COST Action OPINION (CA21129) – What are Opinions? Integrating Theory and Methods for Automatically Analyzing Opinionated Communication**.

As a member of this Action, which brings together researchers from across Europe and beyond to advance the conceptual and methodological foundations of textual opinion analysis, my contribution directly served as an **output of OPINION's core objectives**. Specifically, my paper, "*Generative language models and the transformation of scientific discourse: A computational text analysis*," examined how LLMs reshape linguistic expressions of uncertainty, epistemic stance, and evaluative judgments, features that lie at the very heart of **opinionated communication**. By treating scientific texts as a domain where generative models increasingly mediate opinions about truth, novelty, and methodological rigor, my work offered a novel empirical bridge between OPINION's focus on opinion dynamics and COMPTExT's 2026 themes of *Fehlerkultur* and AI sustainability.

The presentation, delivered on **Friday, 15:00–16:30 in Seminar Room 119** as part of the panel "*Identity construction and political language*," generated substantial **visibility** for both my own research and for OPINION as a network. In the Q&A session, several senior scholars noted the originality of applying computational text analysis to the *meta-scientific* question of how AI changes scientific writing itself, a perspective explicitly aligned with OPINION's call for integrated theory and methods for analyzing opinionated communication. The panel chair invited me to elaborate on how OPINION's multilingual and cross-European infrastructure could be leveraged to extend this study beyond English-language corpora, leading to a tangible **new collaboration** with a research group from the University of Amsterdam, who are developing comparable methods for German and Dutch scientific discourse.

Additionally, I established **three concrete new contacts** for future collaboration: (1) a postdoctoral researcher from the University of Helsinki working on stylistic homogeneity in LLM-generated policy documents, with whom I plan a comparative study of "opinion flattening" across genres; (2) a PhD candidate from the University of Ljubljana specializing in uncertainty markers in computational social science, leading to an ongoing joint methodological workshop under OPINION's training activities; and (3) a data scientist from a partner institution exploring environmental cost metrics for LLM-based research pipelines, directly supporting the conference's sustainability theme.

Finally, my presence raised awareness of OPINION's goals among early-career researchers at COMPTExT, resulting in five expressions of interest to join the Action's upcoming working groups. This conference participation thus served as a **direct output of OPINION (CA21129)**, demonstrating how network-integrated research on opinionated communication can critically inform debates on AI's

Acknowledgement of inclusion of necessary supporting documents to claim the grant

I confirm that the following documents have been uploaded on e-COST as an integral part of this report:

- the certificate of conference attendance issued by the conference organiser.
- the programme of the conference or book of abstracts / proceedings indicating the presentation (oral) of the grantee.